MARKET REPORT

SEWANG LIQUOR · WEEKLY

Year-end party series ③

Diners at the two ends

2026.11.11 · 3 min

Year-end diners went to the two ends

KRW 200,000 course bookings 2x, buffet spending +86% — one move for the KRW 70,000 shop in the middle

Trending shops sell **drinks bundled in**, and they sell **'a reason to come this time'**. Three things for your course menu and a per-head budget template are in **07**.

Pricey end	Cheap end	Middle
Drinks included	This time only	A name

11/13 OPENS

THREE NUMBERS THIS ISSUE

2x — Christmas course bookings over KRW 200,000 per person (in 1 year)

+85.9% — Spending at buffet Gourmet Square (1 year, receipts of 20,000 people)

70,000 — KRW — median published year-end course, Seoul office districts (22 shops)

CatchTable 2026.11.6 · Embrain Deep Data (Korea Economic Daily 11.6) · Sewang survey 11.7

↓ Scroll down · no PDF needed · ☕ Share for an Americano coupon (07 · first 10 people, until 11/14)

01 THIS WEEK'S CALENDAR

Christmas bookings open on 11/13

1/4

1 in 4 Christmas bookings is made in November (last 3 years). This year, bookings to 10/31 are already **1.14x** last year's.

11/11
Wednesday

This issue
The week to set course names and prices

11/13
Friday

Popular shops open bookings
CatchTable, in turn 11/13–22

11/19
Thursday

Suneung exam · Beaujolais Nouveau release
Year-end mode starts this week. December group dinners fall on Fridays 12/4·11·18 — a year when Christmas and New Year's Day are both Fridays

HOW TO READ

CatchTable analysis of Christmas visit bookings, 2023–2025. Platform bookings only, so phone bookings are not included.

SO Set your course names and prices **this week** to make it onto the booking boards.

Source CatchTable 'Christmas Booking Trend Report' 2026.11.6 (Korea Economic Daily · Newstap 11.6–7)

02 END ① THE PRICEY MEAL

Courses over KRW 200,000 2x, drinks are bundled into the price

2x

Christmas course bookings at KRW 200,000+ per person roughly doubled in a year (2.4x vs 2023). Courses of KRW 100,000+ are **26.5%**, and 3 in 5 bookings are **season-only menus**.

Mingles

3 stars · Gangnam

KRW 950,000 per person

Christmas course 12/24–26 — **includes a 4-glass wine pairing**. Even booking-proxy posts have appeared.

Marriott Executive Apartments

Yeouido · Hotel

Group dinner from KRW 1,800,000

Course + **private room for 3 hours + unlimited drinks option**. The dinner course is KRW 150,000 per person.

HOW TO READ

'2x' is by CatchTable booking count (Christmas 2025 vs 2024). Shop prices are from each shop's announcement or press reports.

IN COMMON The pricey end doesn't sell drinks separately — **even the number of glasses and hours go into the price**.

Source CatchTable 2026.11.6 / Herald Economy 2026.11.3 / Segye Ilbo 2026.11.1

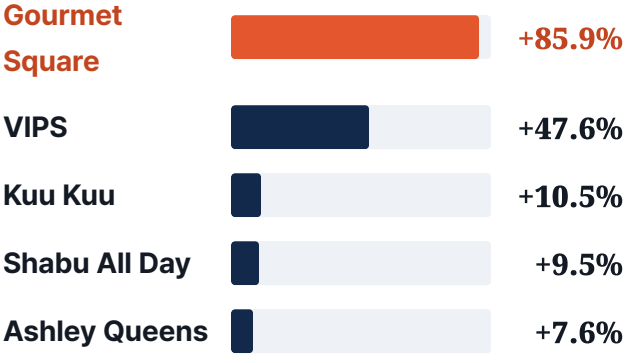
03

END ② THE FILLING MEAL

Buffets grow not on 'more' but on this time only

+85.9%

Gourmet Square spending, 1 year. 9 buffet and all-you-can-eat brands combined: **KRW 1.89 trillion (+8.7%)**. Payments by people in their 60s grew most, at **+21.7%**.



111 items

Ashley Queens seasonal menu this year — 'Asia Market Tour' drew 1 million people in 18 days

2 weeks only

VIPS — chef collaborations + short seasonal menus

HOW TO READ

Bars show each brand's growth in personal spending (%). Estimated from receipts of a 20,000-person consumer panel, 2025.9–2026.8 vs the same period a year earlier. Based on the payer's age, which may differ from the ages of others at the table.

IN COMMON Something new even if you come back a month later —

they keep creating **'a reason to come this time'**.

Source Embrain Deep Data · E-Land Eats · CJ Foodville (Korea Economic Daily 'Trend Watch' 2026.11.6)

04 IS THE MIDDLE GONE?

KakaoTalk quiz answer

The middle survived — only the middle people seek out by name

51.9%

Half of sushi omakase bookings are still in the **KRW 50,000–100,000** range. At the same time, KRW 30,000–50,000 (+14.4%) and KRW 150,000+ (+18%) both grew.



30–50k 16.8% · 50–100k 51.9% · 150k+ 10.9% · Other 20.4%

Quiz — share of KRW 30,000–50,000 omakase bookings: 1.9% in 2022 → this year?

① 5% ② 10% ③ 17% ✔

1.9% in 2022 → **16.8%** in 2026. Even as cheap entry-level options grow, **the KRW 50,000–100,000 range keeps half**.

Dalmaji Gwangjang BBQ

Euljiro 3-ga main branch · street tables

Salt BBQ KRW 26,000

A middle price, yet **waiting numbers in the 200s at 5:30 pm** (11/4 review).

Branches have spread to Seongsu, Sinsa, Pangyo and Suwon, and every review shows a glass of 'ice-cold draft beer' alongside.

HOW TO READ

Omakase figures are CatchTable bookings, 2026.1–8. The '150k+' share is calculated as (30–50k + 150k+ = 27.7%) − 16.8%; 'other' is under 30k and 100–150k. Direct searches for shop names outnumbered searches for 'omakase' by more than 10x.

TAKEAWAY The middle isn't disappearing — **the nameless middle** is.

Source CatchTable sushi omakase data (Venture Square 2026.10.20) / Dalmaji Gwangjang BBQ menu and reviews (Pole · Instagram 11.1–11.7)

05

SEOUL SURVEY · YOUR AREA

Median published year-end course KRW 70,000, only 1 shop bundles drinks

70,000 KRW

22 shops in Seoul office districts that publish a per-person group course price (Gwanghwamun, Yeouido, Magok, Gangnam, Pangyo, Seongsu, Jamsil, etc.). **6** are KRW 50,000 or less.



1 shop	8 shops	13 shops
Drinks included in the course (hotel package)	'Drinks extra' stated	Not mentioned in public posts

HOW TO READ

Bars show the number of shops by price band (KRW) of the cheapest group dinner course. These are shops that publish prices, not the area average — Korean BBQ places and hof (pub) sets booked by phone only are not included.

THE GAP Brands at both ends bundle drinks in, but the middle in our areas sells **drinks separately**.

Source Sewang survey 2026.11.7 — Naver blogs, Instagram notices, articles and menus; addresses checked on KakaoMap · no shop names

06

HOW TRENDING SHOPS SELL DRINKS

They don't sell drinks separately — they sell them bundled

① Highballs as the signature

Yakitori Janjan

Seoul·Gyeonggi highball house

A skewer izakaya on both of GQ's 'top highball houses' lists, Seoul and Gyeonggi. With branches across Seoul and Gyeonggi including Sharosu-gil, Sadang, Seolleung, Suwon and Beomgye, it sells highballs together with skewer sets (Seolleung: 5 kinds for KRW 20,000).

Same approach — **Yukhoegwan Pocha** in Yeouido writes the **whisky name** on the menu, as in 'Maker's Mark highball KRW 11,000' (10/29 review). One line

with a name (e.g. Kakubin highball) explains the price better than 'just a highball'.

② The middle bundles drinks too

Sikdang Minhong · Hakdong, Gangnam

10 courses + unlimited KRW 98,000

Includes nomihodai (all-you-can-drink draft beer, highballs and fresh-fruit sours) (11/4 review). A Japanese course sells a scaled-down version of the 'drinks included' deal only hotels used to offer.

③ One bottle of wine per 4-top

Year-end at BBQ places

750㎖ = about 5 glasses

As small 'own team only' year-end parties grow, BBQ places are pitching Hanwoo + wine pairings. One glass each for 4 people — one bottle fits one table. For a table of 2, 2 highballs are the same share.

④ The queue-worthy street bar: 'one cold glass'

Dalmaji Gwangjang BBQ

Give the set a name

It names its menu bundles, like the 'Ready to Hang Out set KRW 53,000', and pushes ice-cold draft beer (KRW 6,000 in reviews) as its signature glass.

HOW TO READ

Drink prices in ② and ④ come from customer reviews and may differ from official prices. Shop addresses checked on KakaoMap.

Source GQ 'Top highball houses in Seoul · Gyeonggi' 2022.11–12 · DiningCode menu / Instagram reviews 10.29 · 11.4 (collected by Sewang 11.8) / Seoul Economic TV 2026.11.5 / Pole menu. For on-trade whisky and wine items, ask your sales rep.

07

BUDGET TEMPLATE · TO DO

A KRW 49,000 set with 2 highballs · 1 bottle of wine

49,000 KRW / person

PER-PERSON TEMPLATE

[Year-end set · per person]

Pork belly 1.5 servings (300g)	**about KRW 32,000**
1 meal dish (e.g. kimchi-jjigae set)	**about KRW 9,000**
Subtotal	**KRW 41,000**
Drinks share (up to KRW 49,000)	**about KRW 8,000**

2-person set: drinks share about KRW 16,000

= 2 highballs (cost about KRW 2,000 per glass)

4-person set: drinks share about KRW 32,000

= 1 bottle of wine (supply price under KRW 10,000)

Seoul pork belly dining-out price, 200g average KRW 21,321 × 1.5 + kimchi-jjigae set KRW 9,092 (nationwide) = KRW 41,074. Swap in your own prices.

HOW TO READ

Dining-out prices rose +2.9% in October (the highest since February this year). So 'unlimited' doesn't fit this price range — bundle by **the glass**

or bottle. Cost of 1 highball = 40ml whisky about KRW 1,500 + soda, ice and lemon about KRW 400. Wine at a supply price of KRW 7,000–8,000 still leaves about KRW 24,000 per bottle when sold at KRW 32,000.

- [ ] **① One year-end-only name — 'December only'**
  3 in 5 Christmas bookings are season-only menus. Changing the name and one dish of an existing course is enough

- [ ] **② 2-person set: 2 highballs · 4-person set: 1 bottle of wine = KRW 49,000 per person**
  Top preferred year-end party scope: 'own team only' (53.5%). Put a set with drinks on the first line of your course menu

- [ ] **③ A separate year-end lunch price**
  A year when Christmas and New Year's Day are both Fridays — if late December is empty, inquiries for weekday lunches from late Nov to early Dec rise (Magok example)

ASK YOUR SALES REP · THIS WEEK

1. Wine for sets (Chile · Spain · Cava under KRW 10,000 supply price)
2. On-trade whisky for 'named whisky highballs' (Kakubin etc.)
3. A glass to pair with the December-only course (sake · sparkling)

SHARE

Send this to owners in your area ☕

Look at year-end course menus together with the shop next door and the price lines become

clear. **Share by Sat 11/14 and the first 10 people get an Americano coupon code right away.**

Send the link to the owner next door

☕ **Share this issue and get an Americano coupon code right away**

NEXT ISSUE · Wed, Nov 18

First week of December: a check before the peak

Planned (topic not final).

Add our KakaoTalk channel — get the next issue

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Sources (11)

01 CatchTable 'Christmas Booking Trend Report' 2026.11.6 — Christmas bookings 2023–2025 at 2.7–2.8x the December Fri/Sat average; 2025 bookings for courses of KRW 200,000+ about 2x the previous year (2.4x vs 2023); KRW 100,000+ share 26.5%; 3 in 5 season-only menus; 1 in 4 booked in November; to 2026.10.31, 1.14x the same period last year; popular shops open bookings in turn 11/13–22 (Korea Economic Daily · Newstap · Hotel & Restaurant 11.6–7)

02 Herald Economy 2026.11.3 — Mingles Christmas course 12/24–26, KRW 950,000 per person (includes 4-glass wine pairing)

03 Segye Ilbo 2026.11.1 — Marriott Executive Apartments (Yeouido) dinner course KRW 150,000, dinner package from KRW 1,800,000 (private room 3 hours · unlimited drinks option)

04 Korea Economic Daily 'Trend Watch' 2026.11.6 — Embrain Deep Data (receipts of a 20,000-person

panel): spending at 9 buffet and all-you-can-eat brands KRW 1.89 trillion (+8.7%, 2025.9–2026.8), 60s +21.7%, Gourmet Square +85.9 · VIPS +47.6 · Kuu Kuu +10.5 · Shabu All Day +9.5 · Ashley Queens +7.6%; Ashley Queens 111 seasonal menu items · Asia Market Tour 1 million people in 18 days

05 Venture Square 2026.10.20 — CatchTable sushi omakase bookings: 2026.1–8 KRW 30,000–50,000 range +14.4% · KRW 150,000+ +18%; combined share of the two bands 14.1% in 2022 → 27.7%; KRW 30,000–50,000 1.9% → 16.8%; KRW 50,000–100,000 51.9%; shop-name searches more than 10x 'omakase' searches

06 Dalmaji Gwangjang BBQ (112-1 Euljiro, Jung-gu, Seoul, KakaoMap) — menu: salt BBQ KRW 26,000 · 'Ready to Hang Out' set KRW 53,000 (Pole); ice-cold Cass KRW 6,000 · waiting numbers in the 200s (Instagram reviews 11.4 · 11.6)

07 GQ Korea 'Top highball houses in Seoul' 2022.11.24 · 'Top highball houses in Gyeonggi' 2022.12.2 — lists Izakaya Janjan · Yakitori Janjan / DiningCode, Yakitori Janjan Seolleung menu (5 kinds of handmade skewers KRW 20,000)

08 Instagram reviews (collected by Sewang 2026.11.8) — Yukhoegwan Pocha Yeouido (78 Gukjegeumyung-ro, Yeongdeungpo-gu) Maker's Mark highball KRW 11,000 (10.29); Sikdang Minhong (11 Nonhyeon-ro 146-gil, Gangnam-gu) 10 courses + nomihodai KRW 98,000 (11.4). Addresses checked on KakaoMap

09 Seoul Economic TV 2026.11.5 — Incruit survey of 888 office workers: 'own team only' 53.5%; one 750 ml bottle of wine about 5 glasses · 4-person table pairing

10 Korea Consumer Agency price service (Chamgagyeok) — Seoul pork belly 200g KRW 21,321 (2026.8, Korea Economic Daily 8.9) · kimchi-jjigae set KRW 9,092 (nationwide 2026.9, Newsis 10.19) / National Data Office October CPI, dining out +2.9% (11.3) / Newstap 2026.11.4, Magok year-end lunch parties

11 Sewang survey of year-end courses in Seoul office districts, 22 shops (2026.11.7) — KRW 50k or less 6 · 50–60k 3 · 60–80k 6 · 80–100k 4 · 100k+ 3, median about 70.0k; drinks included 1 · stated as extra 8 · unclear 13

※ Shop prices and menus are as of the announcement or review date and may change. The 22 surveyed shops are not named. Platform booking and receipt data do not cover the whole market.

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